STEPIN Tournament

Business Customer Guide

> *This document is a guide for business clients who are new to the STEPIN Tournament platform. It provides an at-a-glance overview of the entire process, from the initial application to host a tournament to its final conclusion.*

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1. What is the STEPIN Tournament?

STEPIN is a global dance-based tournament platform. It operates on a structure where business clients—such as corporations, entertainment agencies, and brands (hereafter referred to as "Hosts")—organize tournaments, and dancers from all over the world participate and compete.

Tournaments are operated via an online app/web-based automated toolkit. Once the host configures the schedule and conditions, the entire workflow—registration → qualifiers → bracket reveal → main tournament progression—runs automatically according to the preset timeline. Participants (users) view and enter tournaments via the app (STEPIN), while hosts configure and manage the events via the web (tournament.stepin.ai).

What You Can Configure During the Setup Phase

These are the elements the host directly plans and configures before the tournament launches.

- Tournament planning and hosting application.
- Recruitment method (Open/Private) and eligible participating countries.
- Number of rounds, progression mode (Synchronous/Asynchronous), and detailed schedules for each phase.
- Competition tracks and detailed prize/reward configurations.
- Detailed tournament information such as posters, banners, supported languages, and official notices.

What You Can Manage During the Operation Phase

These are the elements the host can actively manage while the tournament is ongoing.

- Qualifiers: Configure scoring logic and selection criteria, monitor real-time rankings, and manually select qualifiers if needed.
- Participant Management: For Private Tournaments, manually accept, reject, or invite applicants.
- Bracket Assignment: Select finalists and assign matches; editable until the official reveal.
- Participant Video Management: View and download match videos; toggle in-app visibility ON/OFF.
- Winner Management: Verify winner details, download CSV data, and download all tournament videos via ZIP.

> 💡 *STEPIN Tournament Website: You must have a verified Business Account on tournament.stepin.ai to utilize the tournament hosting features. If you do not have an account, please visit the site to create one and contact SIDEWALK.*

2. Applying for a Business Account

Why You Need a Business Account

A verified business account is mandatory to access the tournament hosting and management features on the STEPIN Tournament website (tournament.stepin.ai).

Application and Approval Process

1. Account Creation: If you do not have a business account, please create one first through the STEPIN app.
   - Settings → Apply for Business Account → Enter Business Account Info → Enter Contact Person Info → Submit.
2. Request Approval: After creating your account, you must contact SIDEWALK to request business account approval to obtain tournament hosting privileges.
3. Inquiry Channels: Please use the official channels below for account approval and hosting inquiries.
   - Website: tournament.stepin.ai
   - Email: cs@sidewalkplay.com

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3. Overall Tournament Process

From the host's perspective, the tournament proceeds through the following workflow. Each stage transitions automatically in sequence, though some stages may be bypassed depending on your configuration.

Stage	Tournament Status	Key Details	Host Action
① Application	Tournament Creation Phase (Submit Info & Wait)	Set tournament conditions and request approval from SIDEWALK.	Fill out and submit the application.
② Preparation	SETUP (Created after approval; pre-reveal setup)	Input essential details such as posters, tracks, and official notices.	Input required fields and publish.
③ Recruitment & Qualifiers	UPCOMING (Pre-reveal) → REGISTER (Registration) → QUALIFIER (Participants compete for scores to advance)	Reveal the event, recruit participants, and select finalists through the qualifier stage.	Manage participants (Accept/Reject if Private).
④ Brackets	SELECTING (Finalize qualifiers and assign brackets) →	Finalize the advancing participants, assign the matchup brackets, and reveal them.	Select finalists and assign matches.

Stage	Tournament Status	Key Details	Host Action
	PREMATCH (Brackets revealed; waiting for matches)		
⑤ Finals (Live)	LIVE: MATCH → EVALUATING (Score calculation) → INTERMISSION (Wait for next round)	Matches proceed round by round. Scores are aggregated before moving to the next round.	Monitor participation and view videos.
⑥ Conclusion	FINISHED (Tournament fully concluded)	Verify final results and manage winner information.	Check the winner list and distribute prizes.

> ⚠️ *Depending on your configuration, certain stages may be skipped. Ex) If proceeding without qualifiers, QUALIFIER and SELECTING are skipped. If Auto-assign is enabled, manual bracket assignment by the host is unnecessary.*

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4. Detailed Breakdown by Stage

① Application Phase

Tournament creation requires completing a 3-page configuration process before final submission. Please review the [Configuration Items] below before proceeding with the application.

Configuration Items (Page 1)

Configuration Item	Options
Title	2~30 characters
Recruitment Mode	Open / Private
Eligible Countries	Global / Manual Country Selection
Number of Rounds	Round of 8 / 16 / 32 / 64 / 128 / 256 / 512 / 1024
Entry Fee	0~1,000 Diamonds (In increments of 5)

Open vs. Private Tournament Comparison

Category	Open Tournament	Private Tournament
Participation	Anyone can freely apply.	Requires host approval or direct invitation.
Host's Role	No participant management required.	Manually Accept / Reject / Invite.

Category	Open Tournament	Private Tournament
Kick-out Capability	Not possible.	Possible (Kicked users cannot re-apply).
Best Suited For	Maximizing participant volume and reach.	Curating participants with specific qualifications or conditions.

Configuration Items (Page 2)

Configuration Item	Options
Time Zone	Selectable from GMT +12 to GMT -12.
Pre-reveal	Select Yes / No
└ Period (If 'Yes')	Enter Start Date & Time / End Date & Time (Minimum 5 mins required).
Registration Period	Enter Start Date & Time / End Date & Time (Minimum 24 hours required). Registration duration: Min. 30 mins ~ Max. 14 days.
Qualifiers	Select Yes / No. If enabled, participants play competition tracks during a set period to accumulate scores. Finalists are determined based on score criteria.
└ Qualifier Criteria	Sum of all scores / Sum of highest scores.
└ Scoring Range	All tracks / Restricted to competition tracks.
└ Selection Mode	Auto / Manual (Select number of participants).
└ Period	Enter Start Date & Time / End Date & Time (Minimum 24 hours required).
└ Finalist Selection Period	Enter End Date & Time (Start Time automatically follows the qualifier end time).
Bracket Assignment	Auto / Manual
Bracket Reveal	Automatically aligns with the end of the Finalist Selection Period.
Progression Mode	Synchronous / Asynchronous
└ Finals Schedule	Auto-adjusts based on the "Number of Rounds" set on Page 1 (Min. 30 mins required per round). The first round must start at least 24 hours after the bracket reveal.

Qualifier Combination Cases

Scoring Logic	Description
Sum of all scores + All tracks	Adds every score obtained across all tracks played.
Sum of all scores + Restricted tracks	Adds scores only from the designated competition tracks.
Sum of highest scores + Restricted tracks	Adds only the highest score achieved on each designated competition track.

Progression Mode & Schedule Settings

Progression Mode	Features	Schedule Configuration
Synchronous	All participants play simultaneously.	Enter the start time for the first round; subsequent rounds calculate automatically. / Min. 15 mins between rounds.
Asynchronous	Participants play freely within a designated time window.	Set the active gameplay window (Min. 1 min ~ Max. 23h 35m). / Min. 25 mins between rounds.

> 📌 *Evaluation time is automatically fixed at 20 minutes post-match. Intermission (break time between rounds) can be set from a minimum of 5 minutes to a maximum of 7 days.*

Configuration Items (Page 3)

Prize and Reward Configuration

Configure prizes and rewards during the application. The default ranks are 1st~3rd, with additional ranks available depending on the bracket size.

Prize Type	Configuration Method
Cash	Select USD / KRW / EUR / IDR. Max 8 digits (No decimals allowed).
Diamonds (In-app)	0~9,999 units.
Physical Goods	Product name (up to 30 characters) + Image (JPEG/PNG, Max 10MB).
Bonus Prizes	Designated by the host regardless of rank / Name + Target Description + Image.

Number of Rounds	Reward Eligible Ranks
All Rounds	1st~3rd + (4th can be added).
Round of 16+	1st~4th + (5th~8th can be added).
Round of 32+	1st~8th + (9th~16th can be added).
Round of 64+	1st~16th + (17th~32nd can be added).
Round of 128+	1st~32nd + (33rd~64th can be added).

Once the 3-step configuration is complete and submitted, it undergoes an internal review by STEPIN. Upon final approval, the tournament will be officially created in the 'SETUP' state.

Common Rejection Reasons:

- Prize quantities or details are ambiguous/unclear.
- History of canceling tournaments without prior authorization.

- Precedent of significant participant complaints during past operations.

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② Preparation

After approval and prior to the public reveal, configure the following. The tournament will only be published once all required items are filled.

Configuration Item	Details
Language Settings	11 languages supported (Korean, English, Japanese, etc.) / 1 Default language mandatory.
Poster	270×312 / Max 10MB JPG or PNG.
Banner & URL	343×484 / Max 10MB JPG or PNG.
Background Color	Select via color palette or direct Hex code input.
Official Notice	Max 3,000 characters per language.
Competition Tracks	Select 5~30 tracks (Searchable via STEPIN charts or Latest Dance tab).

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③ Recruitment and Qualifiers

Pre-reveal (UPCOMING)

Participant (App)

- Can preview tournament details (poster, prizes, tracks, schedule).
- Can tap the 'Get Notified' button to receive an alert when registration begins.

Business Client (Web)

- View-only; no action required.

Registration (REGISTER) — Monitoring Applicants

Participant (App)

- Submits tournament entry.
- For Private Tournaments, must await host approval or receive an invite.
- Can preview and practice the competition tracks.

Business Client (Web)

- Monitor real-time applicant data.

Entry Date	Participant	Nationality	Age Group	Gender	Followers	Following	Tournament Entries (Last 3 months)

- Can filter participants by nationality / age group / gender, or sort by the number of followers or tournament entries.
- If hosting a Private Tournament, the following additional actions are available:
  - Accept / Reject applicants.
  - Send direct invitations to desired users.
  - Revoke approval of accepted participants (revoked users cannot re-apply).
  - Categorize participants using nationality / age group / gender filters.
  - Select desired users by sorting based on criteria like follower count and entry counts.

Qualifiers (QUALIFIER)

Participant (App)

- Accumulates scores by playing designated competition tracks.
- Can check their current rank and whether they are in the safe zone to advance.
  - Top 50%: "You're in the safe zone! Keep practicing to aim for the top!"
  - Top 51~75%: "You're still in the safe zone, but you could be caught up at any time!"
- Can view the full leaderboard.

Business Client (Web)

- View-only; no editing or other actions available.
- Can monitor the following information in real time (auto-refreshes every 10 minutes).

Rank	Participant	Score	Nationality	Age Group	Gender

- Scores are displayed to two decimal places (e.g., 3,333.33).
- Participants who have not played yet are marked with — and sorted in alphabetical order by ID.
- Can check the qualifier period / participation rate / number of entrants.
- Selection Period: Min. 30 minutes ~ Max. 30 days.
- Rankings automatically refresh every 10 minutes.

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④ Bracket Setting (SELECTING → PREMATCH)

Participant (App)

- Waits for the qualifier results without taking any specific action.
- Receives an in-app notification upon confirmation of advancing.

Business Client (Web)

- Selects the finalists and assigns the bracket.
- Proceeds as follows depending on the finalist selection mode:

Selection Mode	Bracket Assignment Mode	Host Action Required
Manual	Manual	Manually select finalists + Manually assign matches.

Selection Mode	Bracket Assignment Mode	Host Action Required
Manual	Auto	Manually select finalists only.
Auto	Manual	Manually assign matches only.
Auto	Auto	No action required (Fully automated).

Assignment Mode	Description
Auto Assignment	The STEPIN system automatically assigns symmetrical seeds based on qualifier rankings (1st vs Last, 2nd vs 2nd-to-Last...).
Manual Assignment	The host manually assigns finalists to each match / Automatically transitions if not completed within the assignment period.

- Can select while verifying the finalists' information.
- The bracket is editable until it is revealed (except when set to Auto + Auto).

> 📌 *The bracket can be edited until it is revealed. However, if set to Auto Selection + Auto Assignment, editing is not possible.*

Bracket Reveal (PREMATCH)

Participant (App)

- Can check the schedule of their first match and their opponent's information.
- Can view the entire bracket.
- Can practice the competition tracks before the match starts.

Business Client (Web)

- View-only; no editing or other actions available.
- Can view the confirmed full bracket in list or visual bracket formats.

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⑤ Finals (LIVE)

LIVE internally repeats in 3 stages: MATCH → EVALUATING → INTERMISSION.

MATCH (Match in Progress)

Participant (App)

- Plays the competition track within the designated period and submits the score.
- Can monitor in real time whether the opponent has completed their turn.

Business Client (Web)

- Monitor real-time participation status for each match.
  - Number and percentage (%) of completed / incomplete participants.
- Can view the scores and videos of each match.

- Can download individual videos or toggle the in-app visibility ON/OFF.

Number of Games per Match

- R1024 ~ R16 (Up to Round of 16): 3 games played.
- R8 ~ FINALS (Quarterfinals to Finals): 5 games played.

EVALUATING (Score Aggregation)

Participant (App)

- Waits for the calculation to be completed.
- Can check the results if calculation is already finished.

Business Client (Web)

- Can check the scores and win/loss records for matches where calculation is completed.
- Can check the results for No Show (non-participation) and FF (forfeit/dropout).
  - FF: When less than half of the game is played.
  - No Show: When the game is not played at all.
- Can download videos and toggle visibility ON/OFF.

INTERMISSION (Round Break)

Participant (App)

- Can preview the opponent's information for the next round and the match schedule.
- Receives the next match details if won, or an elimination message if lost.

Business Client (Web)

- Can view all final result data from the previous round.
- Can check the bracket and advancing participants for the next round.
- Can download videos and toggle visibility ON/OFF.

Handling Special Situations

Situation	Display	System Resolution
No Show	Match not participated	Automatic loss for that participant.
FF (Forfeit)	Left after playing less than half the game	The abandoned game is recorded as FF.

> ⚠️ *When the final round ends, the status immediately transitions to FINISHED without an INTERMISSION.*

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⑥ Conclusion (FINISHED)

Participant (App)

- Can watch the videos of the final 1st~3rd place winners.

- Can check their own final ranking and results.
- Video Management
  - Can individually view and download videos for each match.
  - Can toggle video visibility ON/OFF.
  - Can view both videos simultaneously in a battle format for comparison.

Business Client (Web)

- Bracket: Check win/loss records for all rounds and final 1st~4th places / Download all videos via ZIP.
- Winner List: Check the names, nationalities, contact info, and emails of the winners by rank, and download as a CSV.
- Tournament Overview: Verify the full configuration settings of the tournament.

> 💡 *Designating winners for bonus prizes (prizes awarded regardless of rank) must be coordinated separately with STEPIN.*

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5. Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q. What happens if my hosting application is rejected?

You can check the reason for rejection on the application status page, correct the details, and reapply.

Q. What happens if I fail to complete the bracket assignment within the given period?

If the period expires, the system will automatically complete the assignment. If only partially assigned, the remaining finalists will be automatically assigned to matches.

Q. Can I proceed directly to the finals without a qualifier?

Yes. If you do not configure a qualifier, the QUALIFIER stage is skipped, and the host manually selects the finalists directly from the applied participants.

Q. How are the prize monies distributed to the winners?

You can check the winners' names, nationalities, contact information, and emails on the winner list screen. You can download this as a CSV file, and the host is directly responsible for distributing cash prizes and physical goods.

Q. How do you handle minor (underage) winners?

For minors, a Legal Guardian Information button is displayed on the winner list. By clicking it, you can verify the legal guardian's name, nationality, contact info, email, and their relationship to the participant.

Q. Who selects the winners for the bonus prizes?

The criteria for selecting winners of the bonus prize (a prize awarded to participants regardless of their ranking) are set by the host. The actual designation of the recipients is also determined by the host.

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6. Inquiries and Support

For inquiries related to the STEPIN Tournament, please contact us through the channels below.

Website: tournament.stepin.ai

Email: cs@sidewalkplay.com

Please contact the channels above for tournament hosting applications, approval inquiries, and winner-related coordination.